FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

VEGETABLES, FRESH, TABLE READY (READY-TO-USE)

(GENERAL SPECIFICATION)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the general requirements for ready-to-use fresh vegetables. Additional requirements for the products are covered by the applicable detailed specifications HHH-V-1867/1 through HHH-V-1867/7 (see 6.4).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Kinds. The ready-to-use fresh vegetables covered by this specification shall be of the following kinds (see 6.1):

1. Cabbage
2. Carrots
3. Lettuce
4. Onions, Dry
5. Onions, Green
6. Potatoes, white (Peeled)
7. Radishes

1.2.2 Forms, varieties, types, styles, colors, sizes, counts and grades. Forms, varieties, types, styles, colors, sizes, counts and grades shall be as designated in the detailed specification for each product.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein and in the detailed specification.

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies).

FSC 8915

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(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago Kansas City, MO, Ft. Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-668 - Sanitary Standards for Food Plants.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specification procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

U.S. Department of Agriculture

United States Standards for Cabbage
United States Standards for Grades of Topped Carrots
United States Standards for Grades of Lettuce
United States Standards for Grades of Bermuda-Granex-Grano Type Onions
United States Standards for Grades of Creole Onions
United States Standards for Grades of Onions (Other than Bermuda-Granex-Grano and Creole Types)
United States Standards for Common Green Onions
United States Standards for Grades of Potatoes
United States Standards for Grades of Peeled Potatoes
United States Standards for Grades of Radishes

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

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U.S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20044.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Product requirements. The ready to use vegetables shall be clean and sound products prepared from US No.1 grade or better fresh vegetables by washing with potable water, sorting, peeling, trimming and cutting as applicable. The finished product shall be free from decay and from any defect or defects which materially detract from its edibility, appearance or shipping quality. Unless otherwise specified, the interpretation and determination of requirements including descriptive terms and recommendations, shall be in accordance with the pertinent United States Standards, or United States Standards for Grades, as applicable.

3.2 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall comply in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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3.3 Workmanship. The product shall be prepared in accordance with part 128 of the code of Federal Regulations, Title 21, Human Foods; Current Good Manufacturing, processing, packing or holding. In addition, for Military Agencies, the product shall be processed in establishments meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-668.

3.4 Storage. The finished product shall be kept under refrigeration to maintain quality. Unless otherwise recommended (see /3 lettuce), temperatures lower than 40°F (4.4°C) and higher than 32°F (0°C) are recommended.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. The supplier is responsible for meeting all the provisions of the specification prior to submission of supplies to the Government for acceptance. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed herein, using his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government.

4.2 Preacceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection).

4.2.1 Civil agencies. When specified (see 6.1), inspection of plants producing the product will be conducted upon request of the contracting officer to the appropriate Government inspection agency. Award of contracts will be limited to establishments known to maintain proper sanitary conditions or which have received prior sanitary approval recommended by the inspection agency.

4.2.2 Military agencies. The product shall be rejected if produced in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.3.

4.3 Acceptance inspection.

4.3.1 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein.

4.3.2 Examination for net weight. The sample unit for examination shall be one filled polyethylene bag. Lot size shall be expressed in bags. Sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-3. The acceptable quality level expressed as percent defective shall be 2.5. A net weight more than 2 percent under specified net weight for bags required to have 10 pounds or less, or a net weight more than 1 percent under specified net weight for bags required to have more than 10 pounds shall be a minor defect. Results shall be reported to nearest 1/4 ounce for bags required to have 10 pounds or less and nearest 1/2 ounce for other size bags. Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicate a lot average net weight less than specified net weight.

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4.3.3 Examination of packaging, packing, labeling and marking. Nonconformance to section 5 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Chemical analyses. Chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists in effect on the date of invitation for bids, or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging, level C. The ready-to-use vegetables in the kind, quantity and form, type, size, counts, color, style and grade specified and, as applicable, shall be packaged in a polyethylene bag to afford adequate protection during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements. Alternatively, except for dry and green onions the product shall be packaged under an atmosphere of nitrogen in accordance with normal commercial practice. Alternatively, the product shall be packaged under a vacuum in accordance with normal commercial practice. Net weight shall be as specified (see 6.1). The following minus tolerances from the specified net weight will be allowed in any individual container, provided the average net weight of the container, inspected in accordance with 4.3.2, is not less than the specified net weight: 2 percent for bags required to have 10 pounds or less; 1 percent for bags required to have more than 10 pounds.

5.2 Packing, level C. The product shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The shipping container shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Packages. Packages of the product shall be labeled in accordance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5.3.2 Shipping container. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123 or as specified (see 6.1).

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of specifications.
(b) Kind, forms, variety, size, counts, types, styles, color and grade required as applicable (see 1.2.1 and 1.2.2).

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(c) Quantity (net weight) required.
(d) Special labeling and marking required (see 5.3).

6.2 Contractor's inspection. The contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.3 Destination inspection (Civil agencies only). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.4 The requirements in sections 3 through 5 and notes or ordering data in section 6 of this specification are applicable to the following ready-to-use vegetables.

	Contains requirements of	Contained in
CABBAGE, FRESH	IP/DES-S-25-8	HHH-V-1867/1
CARROTS, FRESH	IP/DES-S-7-0	HHH-V-1867/2
LETTUCE, FRESH	IP/DES/S-7-1	HHH-V-1867/3
ONIONS, DRY	IP/DES-S-4-0	HHH-V-1867/4
ONIONS, GREEN, FRESH	IP/DES-S-6-0	HHH-V-1867/5
POTATOES, WHITE (PEELED)	HHH-P 1394A	HHH-V-1867/6
RADISHES, FRESH	IP/DES-S-24-8	HHH-V-1867/7

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA - FSS
VA - DMS
HEW - NIH, FDA
COM - NBS
USDA - AMS

Project No. 8915-0526

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OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

Vegetables, Fresh, Table Ready (Ready-To-Use) HHH-V-1867/GEN

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

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